

I remember, when my parents asked me that question, thank goodness my reply was “Hopefully never!” My mother was devastated. My father, however, said, “Good for you. You’ll never get rich working on straight salary for someone else. If you’re going to get a job, make sure you get paid on percentage. Otherwise, go work for yourself !”

I too encourage you to work “for yourself.” Start your own business, work on commission, get a percentage of revenue or company profits, or get stock options. Whatever your vehicle, make certain you create a situation that allows you to get paid based on your results.

Personally, I believe just about everyone should own their own business, be it full-time or part-time. The first reason is that by far, *the vast majority of millionaires became rich by being in their own business.*

Secondly, it’s extremely difficult to create wealth when the tax man is grabbing almost half of everything you earn. When you own a business, you can save a small fortune in taxes by writing off a portion of your expenses for such things as your car, travel, education, and even your home. For that reason alone, it’s worth having your own business.

If you don’t have a brilliant business idea, not to worry: you can use someone else’s. First, you can become a commissioned salesperson. Selling is one of the world’s highest-paid professions. If you’re good, you can earn a fortune. Second, you can join a network marketing company. There are dozens of excellent ones, and they have in place all of the products and systems you need to get started immediately. For just a few bucks, you can become a distributor and have all the benefits of owning a business with few of the administrative hassles.

If it resonates with you, network marketing can be a dynamite vehicle for wealth. But, and this is a big but, don’t think for a minute that you’re going to get a free ride. Network marketing will only work if you do. It will take training, time, and energy to succeed. But if you do, incomes in the range of \$20,000 to \$50,000 per month—that’s right, per month—are not uncommon. In any case, just signing up and becoming a part-time distributor will give you some excellent tax advantages, and who knows, maybe you’ll enjoy the product enough to offer it to others and end up making a nice income to boot.

Another option is exchanging your “job” for a “contract” position. If your employer is willing, he or she can hire your company instead of you to do basically what you’re doing now. A few legal requirements have to be fulfilled, but for the most part, if you add one or two more clients, even part-time, you can get paid as a business owner instead of an employee and enjoy business-owner tax benefits. Who knows, those